

Name: _____

A Question of Scale: How Wealthy is Brazil?

Warm-Up

Below is a list of different characteristics that could be used to measure a country's wealth. Put a plus mark (+) next to those measures that you think are good indicators of national wealth. Place a minus mark (-) next to measures you think are poor indicators. If the indicator is neither good nor poor, mark it with a zero (0). Be ready to explain your choices.

1. _____ excellent schools
2. _____ large cities
3. _____ good roads
4. _____ high employment rate
5. _____ internet access for most people
6. _____ an abundance of clean air and fresh water
7. _____ a fast-growing birth rate (a rapidly growing population)
8. _____ economically dependent on one abundant natural resource (like oil)

Background Essay

What is the population and geographic size of Brazil?

Why do Brazilians speak Portuguese and not Spanish?

What are two big problems Brazil has had to deal with for much of its history?

Define favelas.

Why do geographers say that it is important to analyze problems using different scales?

Document A

Title: _____

What does GDP mean? What was Brazil's GDP in 2013?

What is the GDP per capita in Brazil if the population is about 200 million?

What is Brazil's 2013 world ranking according to its GDP? GDP per capita?

Which is a better indicator of a country's wealth: GDP or GDP per capita? Explain your thinking.

On a worldwide scale, how wealthy is Brazil?

Document B

Title: _____

Today, what are the BRIC countries?

What evidence from this document helps prove Brazil is a wealthy country?

What evidence from this document helps prove Brazil is not a wealthy country?

The article mentions that Brazil has given up nuclear weapons and has a free press. How relevant are either of these indicators to a discussion of wealth?

On a worldwide scale, how wealthy is Brazil? Explain your thinking.

Document C

Title: _____

Which region or capital district of Brazil is the wealthiest? What is its per-capita GDP?

Which region or capital district of Brazil is the least wealthy? What is its per-capita GDP?

Does industry seem to influence the wealth of a region? Explain your thinking.

What might explain the contradiction that the Northeast has plenty of mining but is still the poorest region of Brazil in terms of GDP per capita?

Looking at regional differences in wealth, how wealthy is Brazil? Explain your thinking.

Document D

Title: _____

What percentage of the Brazilian population is defined as poor or struggling?

On average, how much money would a struggling Brazilian make per year if he worked every day of the year?

Describe life as a wealthy Paulista.

Are race and poverty linked in Brazil? Explain.

On a local scale, how wealthy is Brazil? Explain your thinking.

Document E
Title: _____
Approximately what percentage of Brazil's population lives in favelas?
Based on the photo, describe favela life.
How does life in a Brazilian favela compare to life in a slum in Lagos or Dhaka?
Are residents of favelas poor? Explain.
On a local scale, how wealthy is Brazil? Explain.

Look at your pre-assessment: Which of the different characteristics you chose to be a good indicator of national wealth does Brazil encompass?

DRAFT Notes: Briefly, answer this question for each geographic scale: **How wealthy is Brazil?**

Include **at least ONE piece of evidence from the documents to support your answer for each scale of analysis.**

National Scale:

Regional Scale:

Local Scale:

Final Draft: Formal Writing Rules apply. Each paragraph should have between 3-5 sentences.

National Scale:

Regional Scale:

Local Scale:
